

I General Provisions

Article 1 Scope of application

- 1.01 The present regulations govern the rights, duties and responsibilities of all parties participating and involved in the preparation and organisation of the 2026/27 UEFA Champions League, including its qualifying phase and play-offs (hereinafter the competition).

Article 2 Definitions

- 2.01 In these regulations, the use of the masculine form refers equally to the feminine, and vice versa.
- 2.02 In the context of these regulations, the following definitions apply:

Commercial exclusive zone

Areas of the match stadium that must be provided free of any commercial advertising or other third-party references. This area includes the entire stadium bowl and competition area, as well as in principle the access routes into the stadium and within the stadium, parking areas, hospitality areas, partner seating, and media areas.

Commercial rights

Any and all commercial rights and opportunities in and in relation to the competition (including all matches), including media rights, marketing rights and data rights.

Competition area

The technical areas as defined in the *IFAB Laws of the Game* and all areas that are primarily used by players and the referee team as well as the officials and venue team members during the match, plus the fourth official's position, any seats in the stands used by either team's sporting delegation, the referee review area (RRA) if video assistant referees are used, the players' tunnel, the team and referee dressing rooms, the medical room and the doping control station.

Data rights

The right to compile and exploit statistics and other data in relation to the competition.

Doping

The occurrence of one or more of the anti-doping rule violations set out in the *UEFA Anti-Doping Regulations*.

Football technologies

Any of the technologies that may be used at competition matches in accordance with the *IFAB Laws of the Game* and in line with UEFA's instructions, e.g. goal-line technology, video assistant referee system, medical video review system.

Goal-line technology (GLT)

A camera-based tracking system used to support the referee's decision as to whether a goal has been scored.

Local organising structure (LOS)

The group of individuals who help organise home matches at the behest of the club participating in the UEFA Champions League and/or the play-offs (or a member association appointed by UEFA), and in close cooperation with UEFA, the minimum composition of which required by UEFA includes representatives of the club's management or the association, the stadium authorities, the safety/security services, the club press officer, the national and local police, the relevant competent authorities and other public bodies and agencies, including the transport network and traffic management services.

Marketing rights

The right to advertise, promote, endorse and market the competition; to conduct public relations activities in relation to the competition; and to exploit all advertising, sponsorship, hospitality, licensing, merchandising, publishing, betting, gaming, retailing, music and franchising opportunities and all other rights of commercial association with the competition (including through ticket promotions).

Media rights

The right to create, distribute and transmit on a linear and/or on-demand basis for reception on a live and/or delayed basis anywhere in the world by any and all means and in any and all media, whether now known or devised in the future (including all forms of television, radio, mobile, wireless and internet distribution), digital, audiovisual, visual and/or audio coverage of the competition and all associated and/or related rights, including fixed media, download and interactive rights.

Non-commercial purposes

Activities without any direct or indirect third-party association necessary for (i) a club to advertise its own matches, (ii) internal archiving purposes and (iii) internal library purposes, but excluding commercial rights and any other activity that UEFA considers commercial in nature.

Partner

Any party accepted by UEFA under contract to exercise the commercial rights, and thereby participating directly or indirectly in the financing of the competition.

UEFA spectator capacity

All seats and allocated standing places in the stadium that comply with the *UEFA Stadium Infrastructure Regulations*, minus any seats permanently assigned to media and broadcasters.

Venue

The location of the stadium of the match, including the area controlled by the relevant competent authorities but also any relevant surrounding areas.

Video assistant referee (VAR)

A match official who may assist the referee in making a decision using replay footage.

- 2.03 In the context of these regulations, any phrase introduced by the terms 'including', 'include', 'in particular', 'for example' or any similar expression is illustrative and does not limit the sense of the words preceding those terms.

Article 3 Entries for the competition

- 3.01 UEFA member associations (hereinafter associations) may enter a certain number of clubs for the competition through their top domestic championships, in accordance with the association coefficient rankings drawn up in line with [Annex D](#). These rankings determine the associations' positions in the access list ([Annex A](#)), which in turn determines the stage at which each club enters the competition. Only one single team per club may be entered.
- 3.02 Associations are represented on the following basis (see [Annex A](#)):
- one representative: winner of the top domestic championship;
 - two representatives: winner and runner-up of the top domestic championship;
 - three representatives: winner, runner-up and third-placed club in the top domestic championship;
 - four representatives: winner, runner-up, third-placed and fourth-placed clubs in the top domestic championship.
- 3.03 Additionally, the UEFA Champions League and UEFA Europa League titleholders are each guaranteed a place in the league phase even if they do not qualify for the competition through their domestic championships. If the UEFA Champions League or UEFA Europa League titleholder qualifies for the UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League through one of its domestic competitions, the number of places to which its association is entitled in the UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League is reduced by one.
- 3.04 If the UEFA Champions League and/or UEFA Europa League titleholder qualifies for the league phase of the competition through its domestic championship, the vacancy created in the league phase is filled as follows, in the following order (see [Annex A](#)):
- A vacancy created by the UEFA Champions League titleholder is filled by the domestic champion with the highest individual club coefficient of all the clubs that qualify for the champions path. The champions path is adapted accordingly, with each subsequent vacancy filled by the club(s) with the highest individual club coefficient(s) of all the clubs in the previous round.

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- b. A vacancy created by the UEFA Europa League titleholder is filled by the club with the best individual club coefficient of all the clubs that qualify for the champions path and the league path, provided that this club is the highest ranked domestically of those from its association that have not already qualified for the league phase of the competition directly. If this condition of being the highest ranked domestic club is not met by the club with the highest individual club coefficient, then the position moves to the club with the next highest individual club coefficient of all clubs in the champions path and league path. Once the vacancy is filled, the champions path or league path is adapted accordingly, with each subsequent vacancy filled by the club(s) with the highest individual club coefficient(s) of all the clubs in the previous round of the corresponding path.
- 3.05 If the UEFA Champions League or UEFA Europa League titleholder qualifies for the qualifying phase or play-offs of the competition, the respective qualifying rounds or play-offs are adapted accordingly, with each vacancy filled by the club(s) with the highest individual club coefficient(s) of all the clubs in the previous round of the corresponding path.
- 3.06 In the event of any other vacancies in the UEFA Champions League, priority is given to the best ranked club(s) of the association(s) ranked highest in the access list for the previous round of the corresponding path.
- 3.07 In the event of further knock-on effects in the UEFA Europa League and/or UEFA Conference League, priority is given to the domestic cup winner(s) in the UEFA Europa League and/or UEFA Conference League (or the club(s) replacing it if it qualifies for the UEFA Champions League) of the association ranked highest in the access list for the previous round of the corresponding path with the exception of clubs qualifying for the second qualifying round of the main path of the UEFA Europa League; in this case, priority is given to the cup winner(s) (or the club(s) replacing it if it qualifies for the UEFA Champions League) in the first qualifying round which are moved up one round (to the second qualifying round of the UEFA Europa League main path).
- 3.08 Finally, the two associations whose affiliated clubs achieved the best collective performance in the previous season of the UEFA men's club competitions (i.e. best season club association coefficient), in accordance with the season coefficient principles (see [Annex D.3](#)), are each entitled to an additional place in the league phase, known as a European performance spot (EPS). The EPS is allocated to the club that finishes the relevant association's domestic championship in the highest position of all those that do not qualify for the league phase of the UEFA Champions League (after any vacancies have been filled in accordance with [Paragraph 3.04](#) to [Paragraph 3.06](#)). The two associations' overall quota of clubs qualifying to UEFA club competitions are each increased by one club.

3.09 Places in the UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League made available by clubs allocated an EPS are filled as follows:

- a. If a club allocated an EPS also qualifies for the UEFA Champions League qualifying phase or play-offs, its place in the qualifying phase or play-offs is allocated to the club that finishes the same association's domestic championship in the highest position of all those that qualify for the league path of the UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League.
- b. If a club allocated an EPS also qualifies for the UEFA Europa League, its place in the UEFA Europa League is allocated to the club that finishes the same association's domestic championship in the highest position of all those that qualify for the UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League.
- c. If a club allocated an EPS also qualifies for the UEFA Conference League, its place in the UEFA Conference League is allocated to the club that finishes the same association's domestic championship in the highest position of all those that qualify for the UEFA Conference League.

Each other representative of the domestic championship concerned enters the UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League at the stage initially reserved for the club ranked immediately above it in the domestic championship. The highest-ranking domestic championship club that did not qualify for any UEFA club competition enters the UEFA Conference League (or the UEFA Europa League in accordance with Paragraph 3.03 of the Regulations of the UEFA Conference League) at the stage initially reserved for the association's lowest-ranking qualifying domestic championship club.

3.10 UEFA issues a circular letter at the beginning of the season confirming the final adapted and rebalanced access list on the basis of the final results in the UEFA club competitions and the domestic competitions and addressing any scenario not covered by these regulations in accordance with the above rules and principles.

Article 4 Admission criteria and procedure

4.01 To be eligible to participate in the competition, clubs must:

- a. have qualified for the competition on sporting merit;
- b. submit the complete, accurate and duly signed versions of the official entry documents (i.e. all documents containing the information deemed necessary by the UEFA administration for ascertaining compliance with the admission criteria, including the *Admission criteria form* attached to these regulations in [Annex H](#)), which must reach the UEFA administration by the deadline set by the latter and communicated to all associations by circular letter in due course;
- c. have obtained a licence issued by the competent national body in accordance with the *UEFA Club Licensing and Financial Sustainability Regulations* and be included in the list of licensing decisions to be submitted by this body to the UEFA administration by the given deadline;
- d. comply with the rules aimed at ensuring the integrity of the competition as defined and to the extent provided for in [Article 5](#);

- e. confirm in writing that they themselves, as well as their players and officials, comply with the *IFAB Laws of the Game* promulgated by the International Football Association Board (IFAB) and agree to respect the statutes (including the principles of fair play as defined therein), regulations, protocols, directives and decisions of UEFA;
- f. confirm in writing that they themselves, as well as their players and officials, agree to recognise the jurisdiction of the Court of Arbitration for Sport (CAS) in Lausanne, Switzerland, as defined in the relevant provisions of the *UEFA Statutes* and agree that any proceedings before the CAS concerning admission to, participation in or exclusion from the competition will be held in an expedited manner in accordance with the *CAS Code of Sports-related Arbitration* and with the directions issued by the CAS, including for provisional or super-provisional measures, to the explicit exclusion of any state or other court;
- g. not have been directly and/or indirectly involved, at any time since 1 March 2016 (i.e. ten years before the entry into force of these regulations), in any activity aimed at arranging or influencing the outcome of a match at national or international level and confirm this to the UEFA administration in writing;
- h. inform UEFA about any and all proceedings before disciplinary bodies or state courts implicating the club or its officials in any activity aimed at arranging or influencing the outcome of a match at national or international level, whether or not the club or its officials have been acquitted.

4.02 If, on the basis of all the factual circumstances and information available to UEFA, UEFA concludes to its comfortable satisfaction that a club has been directly and/or indirectly involved, at any time since 1 March 2016 (i.e. ten years before the entry into force of these regulations), in any activity aimed at arranging or influencing the outcome of a match at national or international level, UEFA will declare such club ineligible to participate in the competition. Such ineligibility is effective for only one football season. When taking its decision, UEFA can rely on, but is not bound by, the decision of a national or international sporting body, arbitral tribunal or state court. UEFA can refrain from declaring a club ineligible to participate in the competition if UEFA is comfortably satisfied that the impact of a decision taken in connection with the same factual circumstances by a national or international sporting body, arbitral tribunal or state court has already had the effect of preventing that club from participating in a UEFA club competition.

4.03 If, on the basis of all the factual circumstances and information available to UEFA, UEFA concludes to its comfortable satisfaction that a club has failed to submit to UEFA in time complete, accurate and duly signed versions of the official entry documents, UEFA shall take the appropriate measures, in particular to protect the good functioning of UEFA club competitions. UEFA may declare that club ineligible to participate in the competition. Any such ineligibility is effective for only one football season.

4.04 In addition or as an alternative to taking the measures as provided for in [Paragraph 4.02](#) and/or [Paragraph 4.03](#), the UEFA Organs for the Administration of Justice can, if the circumstances so justify, also take disciplinary measures in accordance with the *UEFA Disciplinary Regulations*.

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- 4.05 If a club refuses to enter the competition, having qualified for it on sporting merit and obtained a licence from the competent national body, no other club from the same association may be entered in its place and the access list (see [Annex A](#)) is rebalanced accordingly. Furthermore, in such a case, the coefficient of the association concerned is calculated in accordance with the specific rule laid down in [Annex D](#).
- 4.06 The UEFA administration communicates the decisions on admission to the competition as well as any other appropriate measure to the clubs in writing, with a copy to their associations. Such decisions are final.
- 4.07 If, on the basis of a complaint received by UEFA or information available to UEFA, there is a doubt as to whether a club fulfils the admission criteria defined in [Paragraph 4.01\(c\)](#) and [Paragraph 4.01\(d\)](#), the UEFA administration may refer the case to the UEFA Club Financial Control Body, which decides on the admission without delay in accordance with the *Procedural rules governing the UEFA Club Financial Control Body*.
- 4.08 If there is any doubt as to whether a club fulfils other admission criteria than those defined in [Paragraph 4.01\(c\)](#) and/or [Paragraph 4.01\(d\)](#), the UEFA administration may refer the case to the UEFA disciplinary bodies, which decide without delay upon the club's admission in accordance with the *UEFA Disciplinary Regulations*.
- 4.09 UEFA may carry out investigations at any time (even after the end of the competition) to ensure that the admission criteria are or were met until the end of the competition; if such an investigation reveals that one of these criteria is or was no longer met in the course of the competition, the club concerned is liable to disciplinary measures in accordance with the *UEFA Disciplinary Regulations* or the *Procedural rules governing the UEFA Club Financial Control Body*, as applicable.
- 4.10 Subject to [Paragraph 4.05](#), a club that is not admitted to the competition is replaced by the next-best-placed club in the top domestic championship of the same association, provided the new club fulfils the admission criteria and the status of the competition allows such a replacement, safeguarding the sporting integrity of the competition. In such case, the access of the relevant association is adjusted accordingly.

Article 5 Integrity of the competition/multi-club ownership

- 5.01 To ensure the integrity of the UEFA club competitions (i.e. UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League and UEFA Conference League), the club must be able to prove that as at 1 March 2026 the below multi-club ownership criteria were met and the club must continue to comply with the below criteria from that date until the end of the competition season:
- a. No club participating in a UEFA club competition may, either directly or indirectly:
 - i. hold or deal in the securities or shares of any other club participating in a UEFA club competition;
 - ii. be a member of any other club participating in a UEFA club competition;

- iii. be involved in any capacity whatsoever in the management, administration and/or sporting performance of any other club participating in a UEFA club competition; or
 - iv. have any power whatsoever in the management, administration and/or sporting performance of any other club participating in a UEFA club competition.
- b. No one may simultaneously be involved, either directly or indirectly, in any capacity whatsoever in the management, administration and/or sporting performance of more than one club participating in a UEFA club competition.
- c. No individual or legal entity may have control or influence over more than one club participating in a UEFA club competition, such control or influence being defined in this context as:
- i. holding a majority of the shareholders' voting rights;
 - ii. having the right to appoint or remove a majority of the members of the administrative, management or supervisory body of the club;
 - iii. being a shareholder and alone controlling a majority of the shareholders' voting rights pursuant to an agreement entered into with other shareholders of the club; or
 - iv. being able to exercise by any means a decisive influence in the decision-making of the club.

5.02 If two or more clubs fail to meet the criteria aimed at ensuring the integrity of the competition, only one of them may be admitted to a UEFA club competition, in accordance with the following criteria (applicable in descending order) with the exception of the scenarios set out in [Paragraph 5.04](#) and [Paragraph 5.05](#):

- a. the club which qualifies on sporting merit for the most prestigious UEFA club competition (i.e., in descending order: UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League);
- b. the club which was ranked highest in its domestic championship;
- c. the club whose association is ranked highest in the access list (see [Annex A](#)).

5.03 Clubs that are not admitted are replaced in accordance with [Paragraph 4.10](#).

5.04 Exceptionally, provided that the relevant principles of [Paragraph 5.01](#) are respected throughout, a club that was not admitted in application of [Paragraph 5.02](#), and which is replaced in the competition in application of [Paragraph 4.10](#), may still be admitted to another UEFA club competition (i.e. in descending order: UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League) to which the relevant national association has access, respecting the scenarios foreseen by [Paragraph 5.05](#). The access of the respective association is adjusted accordingly.

5.05 This article is not applicable if any of the cases listed under [Paragraph 5.01](#) happens between:

- a. a club qualifying (in accordance with [Article 3](#)) for the UEFA Champions League and entering the league phase directly and a club qualifying for the UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League (see [Annex A](#));

- b. a club qualifying (in accordance with [Article 3](#)) for the UEFA Champions League and entering the playoffs (champions path or league path) or the third qualifying round of the league path directly or for the UEFA Europa League and entering the league phase directly and a club qualifying for the UEFA Conference League (see [Annex A](#)).

Article 6 Duties of the clubs

- 6.01 On entering the competition, participating clubs agree:
- a. to play in the competition until their elimination and to field their strongest team throughout the competition;
 - b. to play all matches under the direction of a head coach who holds the minimum coaching qualification as defined in the *UEFA Club Licensing and Financial Sustainability Regulations*, who is confirmed as the head coach by the relevant national association and who is responsible for the selection, tactics and training of the team and for managing the players and technical staff in the competition area before, during and after the match;
 - c. to stage and play all matches in the competition in accordance with the present regulations;
 - d. to comply with all decisions regarding the competition taken by the UEFA Executive Committee, the UEFA administration or any other competent body and communicated appropriately (by UEFA circular letter or by official letter or email);
 - e. to observe the *UEFA Safety and Security Regulations* for all matches in the competition;
 - f. to stage each match in the competition in a stadium meeting the structural criteria of the stadium category required by [Paragraph 33.01](#);
 - g. to comply with the monitoring requirements set out in the *UEFA Club Licensing and Financial Sustainability Regulations*;
 - h. if appropriate, to confirm that the artificial turf meets the applicable FIFA quality standards and to send the UEFA administration a copy of the required FIFA licensing certificate issued by a FIFA-accredited laboratory no more than 12 months before the entry deadline;
 - i. to indemnify, defend and hold UEFA, its subsidiaries and any LOS and all of their officers, directors, employees, representatives, agents and other auxiliary persons free and harmless against any and all liabilities, obligations, losses, damages, penalties, claims, actions, fines and expenses (including reasonable legal expenses) of whatsoever kind or nature resulting from, arising out of, or attributable to any non-compliance by the club or any of its players, officials, employees, representatives or agents with these regulations;
 - j. to make every reasonable effort to make the players nominated for the respective UEFA season honours available for the relevant award ceremony, and (except in exceptional circumstances) to make the UEFA player of the match available for an interview after the relevant match;

- k. to cooperate with UEFA at any time – and in particular at the end of each match – in the collection of items from the game and players' personal items that could be used by UEFA to create a memorabilia collection to illustrate the heritage of the competition, to the exclusion of any commercial use;
- l. not to represent UEFA or the competition without UEFA's prior written approval;
- m. to update the UEFA administration in writing within 14 working days about any facts and information related to the admission criteria (see [Paragraph 4.01](#)) that have changed since the admission of the club (including changes affecting the official entry documents);
- n. to inform the UEFA administration about any disciplinary procedure opened against the club and/or its players and/or its officials by its association and/or its domestic league for allegedly arranging or influencing the outcome of a match at national level; the same applies for any football-related procedure opened by a state authority against the club and/or its players and/or its officials based on the criminal code;
- o. if applicable and requested, to participate in related UEFA club competitions (e.g. UEFA Super Cup), in intercontinental competitions arranged by UEFA in conjunction with other confederations and in the FIFA Intercontinental Cup;
- p. if they qualify for the league phase of the competition, to take part in the 2026/27 UEFA Youth League with one of their youth teams in accordance with the regulations governing that competition.

6.02 The club may use its name and/or logo provided all the following requirements are satisfied:

- a. The name is mentioned in the statutes of the club;
- b. If required by national law, the name/logo is registered with the chamber of commerce or equivalent body;
- c. The name/logo is registered with the club's association and used in national competitions;
- d. The name/logo does not refer to the name of a commercial partner. Exceptions to this rule may be granted by the UEFA administration in case of particular hardship (e.g. long-term existing name) at the reasoned request of the club concerned.

If so requested, the club must provide the UEFA administration with the necessary evidence.

6.03 By entering the competition in accordance with [Article 4](#), each club authorises UEFA, UEFA subsidiaries and their respective suppliers and partners to:

- a. conduct such activities as are reasonably required for the proper delivery of the commercial programme for the competition, including, in particular, media production (including live and non-live media coverage of the club's team, players and officials); and
- b. enter the club's premises (including the relevant stadium) for the purposes of such media production and all related activities, both during and outside of the actual match.

The activities mentioned above are defined in [Chapter XIII](#), [Chapter XIV](#) and [Annex E](#) of the present regulations and in the *UEFA Champions League Club Manual*.

Article 7 Responsibilities of the associations and clubs

- 7.01 If necessary, visiting clubs must apply for visas from the diplomatic mission of the host country well in advance of their trip. Upon request, the home club must assist the visiting club as much as possible with the visa formalities.
- 7.02 The clubs are responsible for the behaviour of their players, officials, members, supporters and any person carrying out a function at a match on their behalf.
- 7.03 Minimum medical requirements concerning the provision of facilities, equipment and personnel by the home club are set out in the *UEFA Medical Regulations*. For the avoidance of doubt, the home club has sole responsibility for the provision and operation of any facilities and equipment required in the above-mentioned regulations.
- 7.04 The home club (or the host association) is responsible for safety and security before, during and after the match. The home club (or the host association) may be called to account for incidents of any kind and may be disciplined.
- 7.05 The club considered the home club must stage its matches in accordance with the instructions of UEFA (or of a third party acting on UEFA's behalf) and in cooperation with the association concerned. However, the club is considered solely accountable for all of its obligations in this respect.
- 7.06 Clubs are responsible for guaranteeing the application of sustainability principles in their activities throughout the full duration of the competition, through respect for human rights and the environment.
- 7.07 In the weeks prior to each match, clubs must enter the required information into UEFA's TIME platform.
- 7.08 Visiting teams undertake not to play any other matches when travelling to and from away matches in this competition.
- 7.09 UEFA declines all responsibility in the event of conflicts arising from contracts between a club or any of its players, officials, employees, representatives or agents and any third party (including their sponsors, suppliers, manufacturers, broadcasters, agents and players) on account of the provisions of these regulations and/or any other UEFA regulations and such persons' obligations thereunder.

Article 8 Anti-doping

- 8.01 Doping is forbidden and is a punishable offence. In the event of an anti-doping rule violation, UEFA will instigate disciplinary proceedings and take the appropriate disciplinary measures in accordance with the *UEFA Disciplinary Regulations* and the *UEFA Anti-Doping Regulations*. This may include the imposition of provisional measures.

8.02 UEFA may test any player at any time.

Article 9 Fair play

9.01 All UEFA competition matches must be played in accordance with the principles of fair play as defined in the *UEFA Statutes*.

9.02 Fair play assessments are conducted at all matches in the competition in accordance with the *UEFA Fair Play Regulations*, in order to establish association fair play rankings at the end of each season.

Article 10 Insurance

10.01 Irrespective of UEFA's insurance coverage, each club and host association must conclude insurance coverage with reputable insurers at their own cost, in relation to any and all risks, according to the following principles:

- a. Each club must conclude and maintain insurance coverage to fully cover all of its risks in connection with its participation in the competition.
- b. In addition, the home club or the host association must conclude and maintain insurance coverage for the risks in connection with staging and organising matches and which must include third-party liability insurance (for all third parties participating in matches or present at the relevant stadium) providing for appropriate guaranteed sums for damages to persons, objects and property, as well as for pure economic losses corresponding to the specific circumstances of the club or association concerned.
- c. To the same extent as in paragraph b) above, the host association of the final must conclude and maintain insurance coverage to fully cover all of its risks in connection with the staging and organisation of the final.
- d. If the home club or the host association is not the owner of the stadium used, it is also responsible for providing adequate and fully comprehensive insurance cover, including third-party liability and property damage, taken out by the relevant stadium owner and/or tenant.
- e. The home club and the host association must ensure that UEFA is included in all insurance policies as defined in the present paragraph and must hold UEFA harmless from any and all claims for liability arising in relation to the staging and organising of the relevant matches.

10.02 In any case, UEFA may ask anyone involved to provide, free of charge, written releases of liability, hold harmless notes, confirmations and/or copies of the policies concerned in one of UEFA's official languages.

Article 11 Trophy and medals

11.01 The original trophy, which is used for the official presentation ceremony at the final and at other official events approved by UEFA, remains in UEFA's keeping and ownership at all times. A full-size replica trophy, the UEFA Champions League winners' trophy, is awarded to the winning club.

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- 11.02** Replica trophies awarded to winners of the competition (past and current) must remain within the relevant club's control at all times and may not leave the club's country without UEFA's prior written consent (in this respect, clubs must comply with any request from the UEFA administration to confirm the location of the club's replica trophies). Clubs must not permit a replica trophy to be used in any context where a third party (including sponsors and other commercial partners) is granted visibility or in any other way that could lead to an association between any third party and the trophy and/or the competition. Clubs must comply with any trophy use guidelines that the UEFA administration issues.
- 11.03** The winning team is presented with 50 gold medals and the runner-up with 50 silver medals.

Article 12 Intellectual property rights

- 12.01** UEFA is the exclusive owner of all intellectual property rights of the competition, including any current or future rights in all types of audio and visual material of the competition, names, logos, visual identities, brands, music, mascots, medals, plaques, commemorative items, trophies and certain key elements of the official match ball design. Any use of the aforementioned rights, any imitation and/or variation thereof and any other reference to the competition (such as by associating the name of a club with the date of a match) requires the prior written approval of UEFA and must comply with any conditions imposed by UEFA.
- 12.02** All rights to the fixture list and match schedule, as well as any data and statistics (including databases in which such data is stored) in relation to the matches of and players' participation in the competition are the sole and exclusive property of UEFA. No tickets or accreditation may be used by anyone in order to gain access to a stadium for the purposes of collecting or gathering such data, and such activities are expressly prohibited. This prohibition does not apply to the participating clubs, subject to any and all such data collected being used solely for the purposes of instructing their team, players and officials and expressly excluding any other exploitation or use whatsoever.

II Competition System

Article 13 Competition stages

- 13.01 All matches in the competition are played in conformity with the *IFAB Laws of the Game*. The half-time interval lasts 15 minutes.
- 13.02 The competition stages are as follows (see [Annex B](#)):
- a. Qualifying phase, divided into:
 - champions path, composed of:
 - first qualifying round;
 - second qualifying round;
 - third qualifying round;
 - league path, composed of:
 - second qualifying round;
 - third qualifying round;
 - b. Play-offs (champions path and league path)
 - c. UEFA Champions League, composed of:
 - league phase;
 - knockout phase:
 - knockout phase play-offs;
 - round of 16;
 - quarter-finals;
 - semi-finals;
 - final.

Article 14 Draw system – qualifying phase and play-offs

- 14.01 A draw between the same number of seeded and unseeded clubs determines the ties for the qualifying phase and play-offs. Clubs are seeded for these draws in accordance with the club coefficient rankings established at the beginning of the season (see [Annex D](#)) and with the principles set by the UEFA Club Competitions Committee. If, for any reason, any of the participants in the rounds in question are not known at the time of the draw, the coefficient of the club with the higher coefficient of the two clubs involved in an undecided tie is used for the purposes of the draw.
- 14.02 The UEFA administration may form groups for the draw in accordance with the principles set by the UEFA Club Competitions Committee.
- 14.03 A draw is conducted to determine the ties of each match and which team plays the first leg match at home.

Article 15 Match system – qualifying phase and play-offs

- 15.01** The qualifying phase and play-offs follow the knockout system, whereby each team plays each opponent twice, in home and away matches. The team that scores the greater aggregate of goals in the two matches qualifies for the relevant round or stage (as applicable). In the event that the two teams score the same number of goals across the two matches, [Article 21](#) applies.
- 15.02** The UEFA administration may decide that a tie be played in one leg, if circumstances so require, and will set the principles for determining the winner accordingly.
- 15.03** Clubs eliminated in the qualifying phase or play-offs are admitted to the ongoing UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League as shown in the table below, which also indicates where clubs subsequently eliminated from the UEFA Europa League enter the ongoing UEFA Conference League.

UEFA Champions League (UCL) elimination	UEFA Europa League (UEL) entry/UEL elimination	UEFA Conference League (UECL) entry
Champions Path	Champions Path	Champions Path
1st qualifying round		2nd qualifying round
2nd qualifying round	3rd qualifying round	Play-offs
3rd qualifying round	Play-offs (champions & main path)	League phase
Play-offs	League phase	
League Path	Main Path	Main Path
	1st qualifying round	2nd qualifying round
	2nd qualifying round	3rd qualifying round
2nd qualifying round	3rd qualifying round	Play-offs
3rd qualifying round	League phase	
Play-offs	League phase	

Article 16 Draw system – league phase

- 16.01** A draw, which may be conducted digitally, determines the pairings for the league phase. The 36 clubs are divided into four pots of nine clubs. The pots are composed according to the club coefficient rankings established at the beginning of the

season (see [Annex D](#)) and with the UEFA Champions League titleholder being the top seed in pot 1.

- 16.02 The opponents of each team, as well as whether each match is played at home or away, are determined by means of a draw. Each team is drawn against two opponents from each of the four pots and plays one opponent from each pot at home, and the other away. In principle, teams from the same association cannot be drawn against each other and each team may play against a maximum of two opponents from any other one association, subject to [Paragraph 16.03](#).
- 16.03 The UEFA administration may determine alternative conditions for the draw in accordance with the principles set by the UEFA Club Competitions Committee and may adapt any of the conditions of the draw to avoid deadlock situations and/or take into account any relevant constraints in light of decisions taken by the UEFA Executive Committee.

Article 17 Match system – league phase

- 17.01 All league phase matches are played in accordance with the league system, whereby each club plays eight opponents in single-leg ties. Each club plays four home and four away matches.
- 17.02 In principle, a club does not play more than two home or two away matches in a row and each club plays one home match and one away match across the first two matchdays and across the last two matchdays. The UEFA administration may derogate from these rules if necessary.
- 17.03 All 36 clubs are ranked in a single league ranking according to their results (3 points for a win, 1 point for a draw, 0 points for a loss).
- 17.04 The clubs ranked 1 to 8 at the end of league phase qualify for the round of 16. The clubs ranked 9 to 24 qualify for the knockout phase play-offs. The clubs ranked 25 to 36 are eliminated.

Article 18 Equality of points – league phase

- 18.01 If two or more teams are equal on points on completion of the league phase matches, the following criteria are applied, in this order, to determine their rankings:
- Superior goal difference in the league phase
 - Higher number of goals scored in the league phase
 - Higher number of away goals scored in the league phase
 - Higher number of wins in the league phase
 - Higher number of away wins in the league phase
 - Higher number of points obtained collectively by league phase opponents
 - Superior collective goal difference of league phase opponents
 - Higher number of goals scored collectively by league phase opponents
 - Lower disciplinary points total based only on yellow and red cards received by players and team officials in all league phase matches (red card = 3 points, yellow card = 1 point, expulsion for two yellow cards in one match = 3 points)

- j. Higher club coefficient (see [Annex D](#))

Article 19 Draw system – knockout phase

- 19.01** Once the league phase has been completed, 24 clubs enter the knockout phase in predetermined positions based on their ranking at the end of the league phase, as illustrated in [Annex B](#).
- 19.02** The fixtures for the knockout phase play-offs are determined by means of a draw conducted in accordance with the following principles:
- a. The clubs are paired based on their positions at the end of the league phase to form four seeded pairs (clubs in positions 9 and 10, 11 and 12, 13 and 14, and 15 and 16) and four unseeded pairs (positions 17 and 18, 19 and 20, 21 and 22, and 23 and 24).
 - b. The clubs in each seeded pair are drawn against the clubs in each unseeded pair, as illustrated in [Annex B](#): clubs 9 or 10 against clubs 23 or 24, clubs 11 or 12 against clubs 21 or 22, clubs 13 or 14 against clubs 19 or 20, and clubs 15 or 16 against clubs 17 or 18.
 - c. In principle, the seeded clubs play the return leg matches at home.
- 19.03** The fixtures for the round of 16 are determined by means of a draw conducted in accordance with the following principles:
- a. The clubs are paired based on their positions at the end of the league phase to form four seeded pairs (clubs in positions 1 and 2, 3 and 4, 5 and 6, and 7 and 8).
 - b. The clubs in each seeded pair are drawn into one of two positions in the round of 16, as illustrated in [Annex B](#), against the relevant winner of the knockout phase play-offs, whose position is determined by the knockout phase play-off draw in accordance with [Paragraph 19.02](#).
 - c. In principle, the seeded clubs play the return leg matches at home.
- 19.04** The quarter-final and semi-final pairings are determined according to [Annex B](#). Seeded teams, i.e. teams ranked 1 to 4 after the league phase, play the return leg at home in the quarter-finals, and teams ranked 1 and 2 also play the return leg of the semi-finals at home. If a seeded team is beaten in any round, the team that eliminates them takes over their seeding position in the bracket path (i.e. the higher ranking for seeding purposes is not recalculated after each round).
- 19.05** In the final, the team on the silver side of the bracket (as shown in [Annex B](#)) is considered the nominal home team for administrative purposes.
- 19.06** The UEFA administration may determine alternative conditions for each draw in accordance with the principles set by the UEFA Club Competitions Committee and may adapt the conditions of the draw or directly assign positions to take into account any relevant constraints in light of decisions taken by the UEFA Executive Committee.

Article 20 Match system – knockout phase

- 20.01 All knockout phase matches except the final are played in accordance with the knockout system, whereby each club plays each opponent twice, in home and away matches.
- 20.02 The UEFA administration may decide that a tie be played in one leg, if circumstances so require, and will set the principles for determining the winner accordingly.
- 20.03 The team that scores the greater aggregate of goals in the two matches qualifies for the next stage. Otherwise, [Article 21](#) applies.

Article 21 Knockout system, extra time and penalty shoot-outs

- 21.01 For matches played under the knockout system, if the two teams involved in a tie score the same number of goals over the two legs, two 15-minute periods of extra time are played at the end of the second leg. The team that scores more goals during extra time qualifies for the next stage. If both teams score the same number of goals or no goals are scored during extra time, a penalty shoot-out determines which team qualifies for the next stage.
- 21.02 If extra time is required, there is a five-minute break between the end of normal time and the start of extra time. The players remain on the field of play during this five-minute break, at the discretion of the referee.
- 21.03 Penalties are taken in accordance with the *IFAB Laws of the Game*.

Article 22 Match system – final

- 22.01 The final is played as one single match at a neutral and predetermined stadium. If the score is equal at the end of normal time, two 15-minute periods of extra time are played. If one of the teams scores more goals than the other during extra time, that team is declared the winner. If the score is still equal after extra time, the winner is determined by a penalty shoot-out (see [Paragraph 21.03](#)).

III Match Scheduling

Article 23 Match dates and fixtures

- 23.01 All matches are played in accordance with the *UEFA Match Calendar* (see [Annex C](#)). These dates are final and binding on all concerned, subject to the provisions of [Paragraph 24.01](#) and [Paragraph 24.02](#). The following principles apply to this competition:
- a. Matches are played on Tuesdays and Wednesdays, with the exception of the first matchday of the league phase, where matches are played across Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday, and the final, which is played on a Saturday. Exceptions to this rule can be made by the UEFA administration.
 - b. From the play-offs onwards, the UEFA administration decides the match schedule of each round.
 - c. In each round of the knockout phase, each club will, in principle, be scheduled to play once on a Tuesday and once on a Wednesday.

Article 24 Confirmation of fixtures and automatic reversals

- 24.01 The stadiums, dates (in accordance with the calendar in [Annex C](#)) and kick-off times for all qualifying matches are fixed by the home clubs in consultation with their respective associations and must be confirmed to the UEFA administration by the set deadline. The UEFA administration may alter or confirm dates and kick-off times in accordance with the principles set by the UEFA Club Competitions Committee.
- 24.02 If two or more clubs from the same city, within a radius of 50km of each other and/or playing in the same stadium, take part in any of the UEFA club competitions, and if the association and the clubs concerned explicitly declare when entering the clubs that their matches cannot be played on the same day or on consecutive days, the UEFA administration may alter or confirm dates and kick-off times in accordance with the principles set by the UEFA Club Competitions Committee.
- 24.03 The UEFA administration decides on match dates and fixture reversals on a case-by-case basis and in accordance with the applicable principles set by the UEFA Club Competitions Committee. In any case, the UEFA administration reserves the right to impose a match date if the circumstances so require.

Article 25 Stadium announcements and kick-off times

- 25.01 The kick-off times from the play-offs onwards are established by the UEFA administration.
- 25.02 The play-offs and league phase matches all kick off in principle at 21:00 CET. Exceptions to this rule can be made by the UEFA administration.

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- 25.03** Each matchday in the league phase, two of the Tuesday matches, two of the Wednesday matches and - in the case of the first matchday - two of the Thursday matches kick off at 18:45 CET. Exceptions to this rule can be made by the UEFA administration.
- 25.04** The fixtures on the last matchday of the league phase are played simultaneously on Wednesday at 21:00 CET. Exceptions to this rule can be made by the UEFA administration.
- 25.05** Matches in the knockout phase play-offs and the round of 16 kick off at either 18:45 CET or 21:00 CET. Exceptions to this rule can be made by the UEFA administration.
- 25.06** The quarter-finals, semi-finals and final kick off at 21.00 CET. Exceptions to this rule can be made by the UEFA administration.
- 25.07** The stadium announced at the beginning of the competition is considered as the home stadium of the respective club. It may be the ground of the home club or another ground in the same or another city within the territory of its association. Exceptionally, the UEFA administration may accept a stadium in the territory of another UEFA member association if no other suitable stadium is available in the home territory. In principle, stadiums are approved only if direct international flights and/or charter flights are able to land within an acceptable distance of the host city, in the country of the club concerned. All stadiums are subject to the approval of the UEFA administration.
- 25.08** As of the league phase, a club must in principle play all its matches in the competition at one and the same stadium. Additionally, any change of stadium between the play-offs and the league phase must be agreed in advance with UEFA.
- 25.09** The date and stadium of the final are chosen by the UEFA Executive Committee.

Article 26 Changes to the match venue, match stadium or match schedule

- 26.01** If, at any time during the season, the UEFA administration deems that a venue or stadium may not be fit for staging matches of the season in question for whatever reason (including but not limited to pitch, facility and infrastructure, safety and security, operational and/or organisational problems), UEFA may consult the association and club concerned and ask them to propose an alternative venue or stadium, compliant with UEFA's requirements, for all matches as applicable and decided by UEFA. Should the association and club not be able to propose an acceptable alternative venue or stadium by the deadline set by the UEFA administration, UEFA may select an alternative, neutral stadium, which may be in the same venue, in another venue in the territory of the association of the club concerned, or in the territory of another UEFA association. The club concerned will have to make all the necessary arrangements for the staging of some or all future match(es) of the season, in cooperation with the relevant association and competent authorities. The costs of staging the match(es) are borne by the home

club. The UEFA administration takes a final decision on alternative venues/stadiums in due time.

- 26.02** If any party to a match has any reason to doubt whether that particular match can take place as scheduled (including but not limited to pitch, facility and infrastructure, safety and security, operational and/or organisational issues and/or weather conditions), they must notify the UEFA administration immediately. If the UEFA administration receives any such notification, or has any reason itself to believe that a match may not be able to be played as scheduled, it decides if any change will be made to the venue, stadium, date and/or kick-off time. Such a decision by the UEFA administration is final. If the stadium is changed, the costs of staging the match(es) concerned are borne by the home club.
- 26.03** The referee decides if a match which has started must be suspended. This decision is made after consultation with the UEFA match delegate and, when possible, the UEFA administration.
- 26.04** For exceptional circumstances and cases of extreme urgency that may have a significant impact on the running of the competition, and to ensure that a match can take place or can be completed (see [Article 27](#)), if necessary without spectators, the home club must have access to a backup stadium that meets the relevant stadium criteria and is approved by the UEFA administration. For emergency backup stadiums, exceptions can be made to all regular stadium requirements.
- 26.05** In all cases, decisions taken on the basis of this article are without prejudice to any possible disciplinary measures.

Article 27 Rescheduling of matches

- 27.01** If it is decided on the day of a match that the match cannot start or cannot be played in full, the full or remaining match time is, as a rule, played the next day, without prejudice to any possible disciplinary measures. For that purpose, the home clubs must conclude all the necessary agreements to ensure that the required facilities are available and can be operated.
- 27.02** If the match cannot be rescheduled for the next day, the UEFA administration fixes a new date. This may entail exceptions to the regular match calendar (see [Annex C](#)).
- 27.03** As a rule, a rescheduled match is played at the same stadium. If the circumstances require a change of stadium, the UEFA administration must approve the alternative stadium (see [Paragraph 26.04](#)).
- 27.04** In all cases, the UEFA administration must approve the stadium and fix the new kick-off time taking account of the teams' needs wherever possible.
- 27.05** If a club is responsible for any change to the match stadium or match schedule for all or part of a match, that club bears its own expenses as well as any additional travel, board and lodging expenses incurred by the other club, the referee team and the match officers, without prejudice to any possible disciplinary measures.

- 27.06** If the match stadium or match schedule is changed through no fault of either club, each party bears its own expenses related to the original fixture and the rescheduled match or remaining match time.

Article 28 Completion of suspended matches

- 28.01** If the referee decides to suspend a match and a decision is taken that the match is to be completed on a different day, the following conditions apply to the restart of the match:
- a. If the match is resumed the following day, the match restarts with the same players on the field and the same listed substitutes as at the moment the match was suspended. If a player is unable to restart the match, one of the previously listed substitutes may take their place. This is considered as a substitution. If the team has used all of its substitutions by this point, no change can be made. A listed substitute who is unable to take their place on the bench cannot be replaced.
 - b. If the match is resumed at a later date, the match sheet may contain any of the eligible players who were on lists A or B when the match was suspended, irrespective of whether they were actually on the match sheet for the suspended match, with the exception of players suspended for, substituted or sent off during the suspended match. Players who were in play at the time the match was suspended may not be selected on the match sheet as substitutes when the match is resumed.
- 28.02** Whether the match is resumed the following day or at a later stage, the following principles apply:
- a. Any sanctions imposed before the match was suspended remain valid for the remainder of the match.
 - b. Single yellow cards received before the match was suspended are not carried forward to any other matches before the suspended match has been completed.
 - c. Players and/or team officials sent off before the match was suspended cannot be replaced; the number of players and/or team officials allowed when the match is resumed must reflect any such dismissals.
 - d. Players and team officials who were suspended during or in relation to another match played after the match in question was suspended can be included on the match sheet for the remainder of the match.
 - e. The teams can make only the number of substitutions to which they were still entitled when the match was suspended, using their remaining stoppages in play.
 - f. The match must restart where it was suspended (i.e. free-kick, throw-in, goal kick, corner kick, penalty, etc.). If the match was stopped with the ball in play, it is restarted with a dropped ball on the spot where it was suspended.

Article 29 Refusal to play and similar cases

- 29.01** If a club refuses to play or is responsible for a match (including any penalty shoot-out) not taking place or not being played in full, the UEFA disciplinary bodies declare the match forfeited by the club concerned. Moreover, if the circumstances of the case so justify, the UEFA disciplinary bodies may impose any further disciplinary measures deemed appropriate on the club concerned, including disqualification from the competition.
- 29.02** The UEFA disciplinary bodies can validate the result as it stood (i.e. abandon the match) at the moment when the match was suspended if the match result was to the detriment of the club responsible for the match being suspended.
- 29.03** If a club is disqualified or for any reason withdraws from the competition before all its matches in the league phase have been played, the results of all its matches played until that moment remain valid. A calculation of points will need to take place upon completion of the league phase to take the cancelled matches into account. Any club that has not been able to play its scheduled match against a disqualified/withdrawn club is awarded the average number of points earned by all clubs in its same seeding pot against the clubs in the same pot as that disqualified/withdrawn club in home matches, if the affected club was due to play at home, or in away matches if the affected club was due to play away. The league phase points of all matches that have been played, including the points obtained by clubs in matches involving the disqualified/withdrawn club before their disqualification/withdrawal are not adjusted in any way, and all taken into account for the average points calculation.
- 29.04** A club that refuses to play or is responsible for a match not taking place or not being played in full may lose all rights to payments from UEFA, depending on the gravity of the circumstances.
- 29.05** Upon receipt of a reasoned and well-documented request from the aggrieved club(s), the UEFA administration may set an amount of compensation due for financial loss.

IV Player Registration

Article 30 Player eligibility

- 30.01 In order to be eligible to participate in the competition, players must be registered with UEFA to play for a club within the deadlines set out in these regulations, and must fulfil all the conditions set out in the following provisions.
- 30.02 Each player must be duly registered with their national association as playing for the club concerned in accordance with the association's own rules and those of FIFA, notably the *FIFA Regulations on the Status and Transfer of Players*.
- 30.03 Each player taking part in the competition must be in possession of a player registration licence issued by the player's association or a valid passport or identity card, each containing the player's photograph and full date of birth (day, month, year). The referee or the UEFA match delegate may ask to see the passports/identity cards of the players listed on the match sheet.
- 30.04 All players must undergo a medical examination to the extent provided for in the *UEFA Medical Regulations*.
- 30.05 A player may not play in the UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League for more than one club in a single season. Exceptionally, any player who has been fielded in the first, second or third qualifying round or the play-offs of the UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League is entitled to play in the UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League for another club as from the league phase. As from the start of the knockout phase, players can be registered in accordance with [Article 32](#). A substitute player who has not been fielded is entitled to play for another club competing in the UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League in the course of the same season, provided that this player is registered with the UEFA administration in accordance with the present regulations.
- 30.06 The UEFA administration decides on questions of player eligibility. Challenged decisions are dealt with by the UEFA disciplinary bodies.

Article 31 Player lists

- 31.01 Each club is responsible for submitting to UEFA an A list of players (List A) and a B list of players (List B), duly signed by the club and verified, validated and additionally signed by its association. These lists must include the surname, first name, date of birth, shirt number and name (if applicable), nationality and national registration date of all players to be fielded in the UEFA club competition in question, as well as the surname and first name of the head coach and first assistant coach. In addition, the lists must include confirmation from the team doctor that all players have undergone the requested medical examination; the team doctor is solely responsible for ensuring that the requested players' medical examination has been duly performed.

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- 31.02 Only players who are duly registered with UEFA by means of List A or B can validly serve pending suspensions.
- 31.03 The club bears the legal consequences for fielding a player who is not named on List A or B, or who is otherwise not eligible to play.
- 31.04 No club may have more than 25 players on List A during the season. As a minimum, eight places are reserved exclusively for "locally trained players" and no club may have more than four "association-trained players" listed in these eight places on List A. List A must specify the players who qualify as being "locally trained", as well as whether they are "club-trained" or "association-trained".
- 31.05 A "locally trained player" is either a "club-trained player" or an "association-trained player".
- 31.06 A "club-trained player" is a player who, between the ages of 15 (or the start of the season during which the player turns 15) and 21 (or the end of the season during which the player turns 21), and irrespective of the player's nationality and age, has been registered with the player's current club for a period, continuous or not, of three entire seasons (i.e. a period starting with the first official match of the relevant domestic championship and ending with the last official match of that relevant domestic championship) or of 36 months. In the context of this paragraph, the season immediately preceding a player's 15th birthday may be counted if the player's birthday is after the last match of the relevant domestic championship but before or on 30 June (winter championships) or 31 December (summer championships), and the season immediately following the player's 21st birthday may be counted if the player's birthday is on or after 1 July (winter championships) or 1 January (summer championships) but before the first match of the relevant domestic championship.
- 31.07 An "association-trained player" is a player who, between the ages of 15 (or the start of the season during which the player turns 15) and 21 (or the end of the season during which the player turns 21), and irrespective of the player's nationality and age, has been registered with a club or with other clubs affiliated to the same association as that of the player's current club for a period, continuous or not, of three entire seasons (i.e. a period starting with the first official match of the relevant domestic championship and ending with the last official match of that relevant domestic championship) or of 36 months. In the context of this paragraph, the season immediately preceding a player's 15th birthday may be counted if the player's birthday is after the last match of the relevant domestic championship but before or on 30 June (winter championships) or 31 December (summer championships), and the season immediately following the player's 21st birthday may be counted if the player's birthday is on or after 1 July (winter championships) or 1 January (summer championships) but before the first match of the relevant domestic championship.
- 31.08 If a club has fewer than eight locally trained players on its List A, the maximum number of players that can be registered on this list is reduced accordingly.

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- 31.09** List A must be submitted online by the following deadlines:
- a. 2 July 2026 (23:59 CET) for all matches in the first qualifying round;
 - b. 16 July 2026 (23:59 CET) for all matches in the second qualifying round;
 - c. 30 July 2026 (23:59 CET) for all matches in the third qualifying round;
 - d. 13 August 2026 (23:59 CET) for all matches in the play-offs;
 - e. 2 September 2026 (23:59 CET) for all matches from the first match in the league phase up to and including the final.
- 31.10** For the qualifying phase and the play-offs, a club may register a maximum of two new eligible players on List A after the above-mentioned deadlines, provided the quota of locally trained players is respected. This registration must be completed by 23:59 CET the day before the relevant first-leg match and the club's association must confirm in writing that the new player is currently eligible to play at domestic level. If the registration of a new player causes the number of players on List A to exceed 25, the club must remove a player registered previously to reduce the number of players on the list to 25 again.
- 31.11** Each club is entitled to register an unlimited number of players on List B during the season. The list must be submitted by no later than 23.59 CET on the day before the match in question.
- 31.12** A player may be registered on List B if he is born on or after 1 January 2005 and has, since his 15th birthday, been eligible to play for the club concerned for any uninterrupted period of two years, or a total of three consecutive years with a maximum of one loan period to a club from the same association for a period not longer than one year. Players aged 16 may be registered on List B if they have been registered with the participating club for the previous two years without interruption.
- 31.13** Each club must include at least two goalkeepers on List A and at least three in total (List A and List B combined).

31.14 Exceptionally, a replacement of a player registered on List A is permitted after the deadlines set in the present regulations in the following cases and under the following conditions:

- a. Long-term injury or illness of a goalkeeper: the club concerned may temporarily replace the goalkeeper concerned and register a new goalkeeper at any time during the season. The club must complete the official registration of List A with the replacement goalkeeper. An injury or illness of a goalkeeper is considered long-term if it lasts at least 30 days as of the day the injury or onset of illness occurred. If the goalkeeper recovers before the end of this 30-day period, the player remains nonetheless not eligible to participate in any UEFA club competition (i.e. UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League), until the end of such period. The new goalkeeper does not have to be locally trained, even if the replaced goalkeeper was. The club must provide UEFA with the necessary medical evidence in one of UEFA's official languages. Before confirming the replacement, UEFA may require further medical examination of the goalkeeper by an expert appointed by UEFA at the club's expense. Once the injured or ill goalkeeper is fit to be fielded again, he becomes eligible and/or can resume his position in place of his substitute, who must consequently be removed from the list. The return of the original goalkeeper must be announced to the UEFA administration no later than 23:59 CET the day before the next match in which the original goalkeeper is due to play.
- b. Outgoing permanent transfer of one or more goalkeepers: the club concerned may replace the goalkeeper concerned and register a new goalkeeper after matchday 6 and before the end of the league phase. The club must complete the official registration of List A with the replacement goalkeeper. The new goalkeeper does not have to be locally trained, even if the replaced goalkeeper was. If the club qualifies for the knockout phase, the goalkeeper added during the league phase shall be considered as one of the three new players that may be registered for the knockout phase in line with [Article 32](#). At this point the quota of locally trained players on List A must be respected.

c. Long-term injury or illness of an outfield player: during the league phase until matchday 6 included, the club concerned may temporarily replace a maximum of one outfield player and register a new outfield player. The club must complete the official registration of List A with the replacement player, who must have been registered with the club in accordance with [Article 30](#) before the deadline for List A referred to in [Paragraph 31.09\(e\)](#) (i.e. 1 September 2026, 23:59 CET). An injury or illness of an outfield player is considered long-term if it lasts at least 60 days as of the day the injury or onset of illness occurred. If the outfield player recovers before the end of this 60-day period, the player remains nonetheless not eligible to participate in any UEFA club competition (i.e. UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League), until the end of such period. If the replaced outfield player was registered as a club-trained player or an association-trained player, the quotas for club-trained players or association-trained players must be fulfilled with the replacement. The club must provide UEFA with the necessary medical evidence in one of UEFA's official languages. Before confirming the replacement, UEFA may require further medical examination of the outfield player by an expert appointed by UEFA at the club's expense. Once the injured or ill outfield player is fit to be fielded again, he becomes eligible and/or can resume his position in place of his substitute, who must consequently be removed from the list. The return of the original outfield player must be announced to the UEFA administration no later than 23:59 CET the day before the next match in which the original outfield player is due to play.

31.15 With regard to the definition of a 'season' to be found in [Paragraph 31.06](#) to [Paragraph 31.07](#) of these regulations, as far as the determination of locally trained players is concerned, the relevant dates to be taken into account are those of the relevant domestic championship calendar as originally scheduled, i.e. the prolongation of a domestic championship calendar due to an extraordinary situation, such as in the case of the 2019/20 season, is not taken into account. Furthermore, for the 2020/21 season, the period starting with the first official match of the relevant domestic championship and ending with the last official match of that same national championship is counted as a full season regardless of the actual start and end date due to the extraordinary situation.

Article 32 Subsequent registration

32.01 After the completion of the league phase and before the start of the knockout phase, a club may register a maximum of three new eligible players for the remaining matches in the current competition. Such registrations must be completed by 4 February 2027 (23:59 CET) at the latest.

32.02 Exceptionally and without prejudice to [Paragraph 32.01](#), clubs participating in domestic championships that start and end in the same calendar year are entitled to additional player registrations in the following cases:

- a. If more than five players on the club's List A are no longer registered with their national association as playing for the club concerned after completion of the league phase and before the start of the knockout phase, the club may register one additional player, i.e. a total of four new eligible players, for the remaining matches in the current competition.
- b. If more than seven players on the club's List A are no longer registered with their national association as playing for the club concerned after completion of the league phase and before the start of the knockout phase, the club may register two additional players, i.e. a total of five new eligible players, for the remaining matches in the current competition.

Such exceptional registrations must be completed by 4 February 2027 (23:59 CET) at the latest.

32.03 Any or all of the players from the above quota may have been fielded for another club in the qualifying phase, play-offs or league phase of the UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League.

32.04 If the registration of such new players causes the number of players on List A to exceed 25, the club must remove the necessary number of currently registered players to reduce the List A to 25 players again. The quota of locally trained players must be respected when registering new players.

V Stadium Infrastructure

Article 33 Stadiums

- 33.01** Unless stipulated otherwise in these regulations, each match must be played in a stadium that meets the structural criteria defined in the *UEFA Stadium Infrastructure Regulations* for the relevant category, as follows:
- a. category 2 for the first and second qualifying rounds;
 - b. category 3 for the third qualifying round;
UEFA may exceptionally approve a category 2 stadium for the third qualifying round provided that all public entrances are equipped with an electronic ticket control system designed to prevent the use of counterfeit tickets and deliver real-time flow rates and entrance numbers to a central point with a view to preventing overcrowding in the stadium as a whole or in individual sectors;
 - c. category 4 from the play-offs to the semi-finals.
- 33.02** UEFA representatives may conduct a site visit of each stadium.
- 33.03** The final will be played in a stadium that meets the structural criteria defined in the staging agreement.

Article 34 Pitches

- 34.01** The home club must make every reasonable effort to ensure that the pitch is in the best possible condition for play. If the climatic conditions so require, facilities such as pitch heating and a pitch cover must be provided to ensure that the field of play is in a suitable condition on every match date. The UEFA administration or a third party mandated by UEFA may carry out pitch inspections at any time before and during the competition to check whether the pitch is in a suitable condition to host matches of the competition. Following any initial pitch inspection and recommendation report, the cost of any further inspections or the provision of expert guidance or material by a third party shall be assumed by the club concerned. Clubs are requested to cooperate fully with all such inspections.
- 34.02** The clubs must respect the relevant pitch protection maps for both MD-1 training sessions (if applicable), the pre-match warm-ups and post-match cool-downs.
- 34.03** Any full or partial replacement of a pitch ahead of a match must be communicated to UEFA in advance. UEFA reserves the right to inspect the pitch. No change in surface from natural grass to artificial turf or vice versa is permitted after the first match of the league phase.
- 34.04** The home club must respect the pitch-cutting guidelines for natural grass pitches. The height of the grass must not exceed 30mm and the entire playing surface must be cut to the same height. The height of the grass should be the same for both the training sessions and the match. If deemed necessary by the referee or the UEFA match delegate, the home club may be required to reduce the height of the grass for the match and training sessions.

34.05 The pitch-watering schedule must be communicated by the home club at the organisational meeting. The pitch must be watered evenly and not only in certain areas. As a general rule, pitch watering must finish 60 minutes before kick-off. However, upon the decision of the home club, pitch watering may also take place after that time:

- a. between 10 and 5 minutes before kick-off; and/or
- b. during half-time, for a maximum of 5 minutes.

The referee is entitled to request changes to the pitch-watering schedule.

34.06 All field markings and goals must be in accordance with the *IFAB Laws of the Game* and the *UEFA Stadium Infrastructure Regulations*. No additional structural elements or physical supports may be used inside the net or in its immediate surroundings other than bars fixing the goal net to the ground and goal net stanchions behind and outside the net. Portable goals must not be used.

34.07 The home club is responsible for ensuring that the area immediately adjacent to the field of play is safe for players, team officials and the referee team in accordance with the *UEFA Stadium Infrastructure Regulations*. This includes, but is not limited to, temporarily installing additional, high-quality, green artificial turf around the field of play if necessary.

Article 35 Artificial turf

35.01 With the exception of the final, which will be played on natural turf, matches in the competition may be played on artificial turf in accordance with the *UEFA Stadium Infrastructure Regulations* and provided that such artificial turf is certified as FIFA Quality Pro. By 2 June 2026, the home club must submit a copy of such certification, which must be valid for the duration of the entire competition season.

35.02 The home club is fully responsible for meeting the above requirements and, if necessary, must conclude appropriate agreements with the owner of the artificial turf, in particular those relating to:

- a. maintenance work and ongoing improvement measures; and
- b. safety and environmental measures as set out in the *FIFA Quality Programme for Football Turf – Test Manual I: Test Methods* and the *FIFA Quality Programme for Football Turf – Test Manual II: Test Requirements*.

35.03 The home club must obtain sufficient warranties and/or guarantees relating to the material and the installation of the artificial turf by the owner, manufacturer and installer.

35.04 UEFA cannot be held responsible for any damages to third parties resulting from the use of the artificial turf.

Article 36 Floodlights

- 36.01** Matches in the qualifying phase may be played in daylight or under floodlights. As of the play-offs, all matches must be played under floodlights. For matches played under floodlights, the illuminance level must correspond to the requirements set out in the *UEFA Stadium Infrastructure Regulations* for the relevant stadium category in accordance with [Paragraph 33.01](#) of these regulations.
- 36.02** As of the league phase, matches must be played under floodlights with an average horizontal illuminance level of at least 1,500 Eh (lux) and uniformity ratios of $U1 > 0.50$ and $U2 > 0.70$. The average vertical illuminance level must be at least 1,250 Ev (lux) and the uniformity ratios must be $U1 > 0.40$ and $U2 > 0.50$. Glare ratings (R_G) must be less than 50 and pitch illuminance levels should have a colour rendering (R_a) of at least 80.
- 36.03** Clubs must ensure that the stadium floodlight system is regularly maintained to meet the minimum illuminance values. UEFA may conduct an independent assessment of lighting levels in stadiums and will notify the clubs in good time of the results of such assessments and of any corrections to be made.
- 36.04** For matches played under floodlights, full floodlighting must be provided for training sessions the day before the match and from two hours before kick-off, unless it is required earlier for operational purposes (e.g. calibration of GLT). Furthermore, the use of LED floodlight entertainment (light show) may be permitted according to the principles determined in the *UEFA Stadium Entertainment Lighting Guide*. Any such use may only take place either before the warm-up, between the warm-up and the players leaving the tunnel for the match, or after the match. Exceptions may be agreed with UEFA in specific circumstances (e.g. during a moment of silence).

Article 37 Football technologies

- 37.01** Certain football technologies may be used, if decided by UEFA, in accordance with the *IFAB Laws of the Game* and the relevant FIFA Quality Programmes.
- 37.02** Each club authorises UEFA and UEFA's suppliers to install the football technologies approved by UEFA for the competition in its stadium. The club and the stadium owner/operator must cooperate with UEFA and its suppliers and provide them with reasonable access to the stadium and stadium facilities at all times for this purpose (including for all purposes relating to the FIFA Quality Programme certifications). The club must not use or move, and must ensure that no third party other than UEFA or its suppliers uses or moves, any of the equipment or cabling installed at its stadium in connection with the approved football technologies.
- 37.03** The club is responsible for ensuring the integrity and security of any equipment installed by UEFA and/or its suppliers in the stadium between UEFA competition matches. If any equipment is moved and/or damaged between matches, the club may be held liable for the cost of repair and/or replacement as well as any related costs (e.g. recertification) of the equipment in question. If the club, stadium owner

or stadium operator need to move any such equipment for any construction/renovation work, other events in the stadium or for any other reason, the club may be liable for the costs of removal, reinstallation and, if necessary, recertification, even if such removal is carried out by UEFA and/or its suppliers at the club's request and/or with the club's agreement.

- 37.04** Host clubs may use pre-installed and certified GLT systems during the qualifying phase, subject to UEFA's approval and the visiting club's consent. The host club remains fully responsible for the operation of the system and bears all the associated costs.
- 37.05** For the purposes of VAR, during the qualifying phase, the home club is obliged to contract a broadcast or technical partner to produce a broadcast output of the match, even if the match itself is not televised.

VI Equipment

Article 38 Applicable regulations

- 38.01** The *UEFA Equipment Regulations* apply to all matches in the competition, unless specified otherwise in these regulations, at the following times:
- a. during any activities in the stadium the day before the match;
 - b. at any official training session before the match;
 - c. during any media activities (in particular for interviews, press conferences and appearances in the mixed zone) the day before the match, and on matchday before and after the match;
 - d. on the day of the match, from the team's arrival at the stadium until departure from the stadium.
- 38.02** Exceptionally, the domestic equipment regulations of each team's own association apply to all matches in the qualifying phase, provided that the sponsor advertising on the playing attire complies with Article 27 of the *UEFA Equipment Regulations* and the playing attire has been approved for and worn in domestic competition matches.

Article 39 Playing attire approval

- 39.01** All teams must submit the playing attire approval form online to the UEFA administration by the given deadline.
- 39.02** The playing attire used by clubs as of the play-offs must be approved by the UEFA administration. The following deadlines apply for the submission to the UEFA administration of samples of the first-choice and second-choice sets of playing attire for outfield players as well as any additional sets of playing attire and/or items of playing attire (shirt, shorts or socks):
- a. 6 July 2026 for clubs that qualify directly for the play-offs or the league phase;
 - b. 31 July 2026 for clubs that qualify for the third qualifying round.

Article 40 Colours

- 40.01** For all competition matches, teams must submit the agreed playing attire colours to be worn for each match via the dedicated online tool. The home team has the first choice as to which of its official sets of playing attire registered online it wears for its home matches.
- a. In the qualifying phase, the proposed colours are validated on-site by the referee team.
 - b. As of the play-offs, the proposed colours are validated in advance by the UEFA administration.

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- 40.02** If the referee notices on the spot that the colours of the two teams could lead to confusion, a final decision on the colours is taken in consultation with the UEFA match delegate and the UEFA administration. As a rule, in such cases it is the home team that has to change colours.
- 40.03** For the final, both teams may wear their first choice playing attire. However, if there is a colour clash, the team designated as the away team must wear alternative colours.

Article 41 Numbers and names

- 41.01** From the play-offs, player names must be shown on the back of shirts (see the *UEFA Equipment Regulations*).
- 41.02** From the league phase, all registered players, including those registered at a later stage, must wear set numbers (on shirts and shorts) between 1 and 99. If the number 1 is used, it must be worn by a goalkeeper. No player may wear more than one number for the same team.

Article 42 Attire sponsors

- 42.01** From the play-offs, only the approved sponsors may appear on attire.
- 42.02** Clubs may change their attire sponsors during the season as follows:
- a. a club that participates in the play-offs may change each attire sponsor no more than twice during the same UEFA season and only once from the beginning of the league phase;
 - b. a club that qualifies directly for the league phase may change each attire sponsor only once during the same UEFA season.
- 42.03** Starting the competition without a sponsor but subsequently using one is not considered as a change of sponsor.
- 42.04** A change regarding the content of sponsor advertising is considered to be a change of sponsor, even if the sponsor remains the same.
- 42.05** If a club wants to change its attire sponsor, it must submit a request to the UEFA administration at least seven working days prior to the first match in which it wishes to use the new sponsor, accompanied by the items defined in the *UEFA Equipment Regulations*.
- 42.06** Clubs that have qualified for the knockout phase must announce any change of attire sponsor to the UEFA administration by 5 February 2027 (12:00 CET) at the latest. No change of sponsor is permitted after this time.

Article 43 Badges

- 43.01** From the play-offs onwards, the UEFA Champions League competition badge must appear on the free zone of the right shirt sleeve. The UEFA Champions League badge may not be used in any other competition or at any earlier stage of the

competition. Multiple winners of the UEFA Champions League (three consecutive times or a minimum of five times) will be provided with a multiple winner edition of the UEFA Champions League competition badge.

- 43.02 The titleholder must wear the UEFA Champions League titleholder badge instead of the UEFA Champions League competition badge on the free zone of the right shirt sleeve. The UEFA Champions League titleholder badge may not be used in any other competition. If the titleholder is also a multiple winner of the UEFA Champions League they will be provided with a multiple winner edition of the UEFA Champions League titleholder badge.
- 43.03 The UEFA Europa League titleholder must wear the UEFA Europa League titleholder badge (UEFA Champions League edition) on the free zone of the right shirt sleeve. The UEFA Europa League titleholder badge (UEFA Champions League edition) may not be used in any other competition.
- 43.04 The applicable UEFA campaign badge must also be worn on the free zone of the right shirt sleeve from the first match in the play-offs onwards.

Article 44 Other team equipment

- 44.01 From the play-offs onwards, non-playing attire worn by players and club officials may contain sponsor advertising and manufacturer identification in accordance with the *UEFA Equipment Regulations*.
- 44.02 From the play-offs onwards, all additional special equipment, such as kit bags, medical bags, drink containers, blankets, towels, etc. must be free of any manufacturer identification or sponsor advertising unless indicated otherwise in the *UEFA Equipment Regulations*.

VII Ticketing and Accreditations

Article 45 Visiting team tickets

- 45.01 Home clubs must make at least 5% of the UEFA spectator capacity available to visiting supporters in line with the *UEFA Stadium Infrastructure Regulations* and the *UEFA Safety and Security Regulations*. The price of the corresponding tickets must not exceed the price paid by supporters of the home team for adult tickets in a comparable sector of the stadium (including tickets sold to season ticket holders, to members of the club and/or as part of any promotion or promotional package comprising tickets exclusively for UEFA competition matches). Furthermore, in no case shall the price of those tickets for visiting supporters exceed €50.
- 45.02 Visiting clubs must, where relevant, sell their tickets by zone in order to facilitate the reallocation of unsold tickets. Visiting clubs that have requested an allocation of tickets for the whole or part of the segregated area may return any unused tickets to the home club without payment up to seven days prior to the match. After this deadline, the visiting club must pay for the whole allocation, irrespective of whether all the tickets have been sold.
- 45.03 The home club may reallocate tickets returned or not requested by the visiting club provided that all safety and security measures (as mentioned in the *UEFA Safety and Security Regulations*) are respected and that such tickets are not reallocated to supporters of the visiting club.
- 45.04 Visiting clubs are entitled to receive 200 top-category tickets for their premium supporters, sponsors, etc., but they are not obliged to take the full allocation.
- a. 75 of these tickets must be provided on a complimentary basis, and the rest are to be made available for purchase. In this regard:
 - i. for all matches played on a home-away basis (i.e. for qualifying phase, play-off and knockout phase matches), the ticket price of the purchase allocation is set for both matches at the higher price charged between the two clubs (which must be set subject to the provisions of Paragraph 20.01 of the *UEFA Safety and Security Regulations*);
 - ii. for matches of the league phase, the ticket price of the purchase allocation must be set in line with the provisions of Paragraph 20.01 of the *UEFA Safety and Security Regulations*.
 - b. Unused complimentary tickets must be returned no later than seven days before the match in question. The visiting club may be charged for any tickets not returned by this deadline that remain unused, with the price determined in accordance with Paragraph 45.04(a) above.
 - c. These tickets are to be located in the next highest category of seats after those providing access to the home club's VIP area. They must be located in a single block, with appropriate stewarding and segregation, and must fulfil the following conditions:
 - i. Located on the same side of the stadium as the visiting club's VIP seats (as referred to in [Paragraph 46.01](#)),

- ii. Located between the two 16m lines, and
- iii. Located approximately midway up the stands.

In addition, visiting clubs are entitled to receive 35 tickets for their UEFA Youth League delegation on a complimentary basis. These tickets should ideally be in the same block as the 200 top-category tickets.

- 45.05 All visiting team ticket allocations and ticketing arrangements, except those related to the ticket price cap for visiting supporter tickets, may be altered by written agreement between the two clubs concerned. Any reduction in the standard ticket allocation should, however, only be agreed to if there is a specific lack of demand from the supporters of the visiting team for the match in question.

Article 46 Tickets with hospitality service

- 46.01 The official UEFA representatives and at least 20 representatives of the visiting club and its association must be provided with complimentary VIP seats and associated hospitality in the VIP sector in the area usually used by the home club's president or chief executive officer in accordance with Article 25 of the *UEFA Stadium Infrastructure Regulations*.
- 46.02 The clubs may produce posters, tickets and other official printed matter in connection with the UEFA Champions League and the play-offs in a manner approved by UEFA and in accordance with UEFA's ticketing policy. When posters, tickets and official printed matter connected with UEFA Champions League and/or play-off matches are being designed, due attention must be paid to ensuring that any advertising overprint is solely that of the partners. All printed matter must be produced in accordance with the guidelines laid down by UEFA.
- 46.03 For matches of the play-offs, the league phase and the knockout phase, the clubs undertake to provide UEFA with the following numbers of complimentary tickets for the VIP area, including hospitality at no additional charge, for use by UEFA and its partners:
- a. Play-off matches: 10
 - b. League phase matches: 50
 - c. Knockout phase play-off matches: 50
 - d. Round of 16 matches: 50
 - e. Quarter-finals: 50
 - f. Semi-finals: 50
- 46.04 The number of tickets and hospitality passes mentioned in [Paragraph 46.03](#) must not exceed 10% of the seating capacity of the VIP area. If it does, the club should provide UEFA with tickets equating to 10% of the VIP area and should make up the remaining number in accordance with [Paragraph 46.03](#) by providing complimentary tickets, including hospitality at no additional charge, in the next highest category. All such tickets must be in one block, in a section located between the two 16m lines. However, upon UEFA's request, clubs must seat up to five of

UEFA's VIP ticket holders in the best possible seats next to the UEFA match delegate and/or the club's highest level executives.

- 46.05** Likewise, UEFA must be provided with complimentary tickets of the next highest category after those providing access to the home club's VIP area for use by UEFA and its partners. These tickets must be located in a single block, in a section located between the two 16m lines and within the same tier level of the stadium, for use by UEFA and its partners. The following numbers of tickets must be provided:
- a. Play-off matches: 50
 - b. League phase matches: 330, plus up to 42 that UEFA may purchase at retail price
 - c. Knockout phase play-off matches: 380, plus up to 45 that UEFA may purchase at retail price
 - d. Round of 16 matches: 380, plus up to 45 that UEFA may purchase at retail price
 - e. Quarter-finals: 425, plus up to 52 that UEFA may purchase at retail price
 - f. Semi-finals: 475, plus up to 51 that UEFA may purchase at retail price
- 46.06** In addition, UEFA and its partners must be given the opportunity to acquire, at face value, the following numbers of retail tickets, whereby tickets in the next highest category must also be situated in one block and in a central section (i.e. not behind the goal):
- a. Play-off matches: minimum of 350 top-category retail tickets, 370 retail tickets in the next highest category and 220 retail tickets in the third highest category
 - b. League phase matches: minimum of 308 top-category retail tickets, 370 retail tickets in the next highest category and 230 retail tickets in the third highest category
 - c. Knockout phase play-off matches: minimum of 365 top-category retail tickets, 460 retail tickets in the next highest category and 360 retail tickets in the third highest category
 - d. Round of 16 matches: minimum of 365 top-category retail tickets, 460 retail tickets in the next highest category and 360 retail tickets in the third highest category
 - e. Quarter-finals: minimum of 608 top-category retail tickets, 710 retail tickets in the next highest category and 640 retail tickets in the third highest category
 - f. Semi-finals: minimum of 829 top-category retail tickets, 920 retail tickets in the next highest category and 730 retail tickets in the third highest category
- 46.07** The clubs are responsible for dispatching tickets and hospitality and parking passes to UEFA and/or the partners in accordance with UEFA's instructions.
- 46.08** All tickets must be official UEFA Champions League or play-off tickets approved by UEFA prior to production.
- 46.09** The clubs shall ensure that their ticketing and media accreditation terms and conditions for the matches stipulate as a minimum that:
- a. no person may conduct any promotional or commercial activity at the match stadium without the prior written approval of UEFA;

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- b. tickets must not be used for any commercial purposes such as for promotion, advertising, use as a prize in a competition/sweepstake, or as part of a hospitality or travel package without the prior written approval of UEFA;
 - c. all people attending the match acknowledge that use may be made (free of charge) of their voice, image and/or likeness in still images and audio/visual transmissions relating to the match;
 - d. no person attending the match may, without UEFA's prior written approval, collect, record, transmit and/or exploit any sound, image, data, statistics and/or description of the match for any purpose other than for private use. Upon request by UEFA, the club must make every effort to provide the necessary support to enforce the aforementioned provision.

Article 47 Accreditations

- 47.01 A number of accreditations for partners, to be agreed upon, will be made available by UEFA in conjunction with the home club. In every case, accreditation will ensure that all services can be provided before, during and after the match.
- 47.02 For the qualifying phase matches, the home club must ensure that the venue data coordinator (VDC) appointed by UEFA to gather live data during the match is provided with:
 - a. accreditation permitting access to a commentary position (or an equivalent position) with dedicated broadband internet access, which needs to be in place from the morning of the match until 90 minutes after the final whistle; and
 - b. accreditation permitting access to the referees' dressing room.

VIII Match Organisation

Article 48 Team arrivals

- 48.01 The clubs must arrange for their teams to arrive on-site by the evening before the match concerned at the latest, and in time to fulfil their media obligations the day before the match.

Article 49 Training sessions

- 49.01 The day before the match, pitch conditions permitting, the visiting team is allowed to train for a duration of one hour at the match stadium unless agreed otherwise with UEFA and the home team. If the home team is also holding a training session in the stadium and both teams wish to train at the same time, priority is given to the visiting team. The visiting team may not hold any other training sessions at the match stadium. If holding training sessions could render the pitch unfit for play the next day, an alternative training ground approved ad hoc by UEFA must be made available. UEFA may decide, for the purposes of protecting the pitch for the match, that one or both training sessions must be relocated to the alternative training ground. Any requests to relocate any training sessions to the alternative training ground must be approved by UEFA. In all cases, priority is given to the visiting team, so the first training session to be moved is that of the home team. Both teams may be allowed to train at the match stadium at the same time with each limited to certain areas of the pitch, provided that these space restrictions are notified in writing to each team.
- 49.02 In principle, the stadium's retractable roof should be in the same position as anticipated for the match, subject to prevailing weather conditions.
- 49.03 Pitch watering ahead of a visiting team's official training session at the stadium must be agreed between the two teams.
- 49.04 The day before the match, pitch conditions permitting, the referee team may train at the match stadium. If such a training session is not possible as a result of pitch conditions or travel times, an alternative facility should be made available.
- 49.05 If the visiting team and/or referees do not train at the stadium the day before a match for whatever reason (e.g. pitch conditions), they must be permitted to visit the stadium the day before the match.
- 49.06 If the visiting team requests a cool down after the match, it must be communicated at the organisational meeting and should include all relevant information (e.g. duration, number of players, type of exercises). Such requests are subject to the approval of the home club, and, in some cases, the relevant competent authorities.

Article 50 Match equipment

- 50.01** For the qualifying phase, balls must comply with the *IFAB Laws of the Game* as well as with the *UEFA Equipment Regulations*. The home club must provide the visiting team with match balls of excellent quality for its training session on the day before the match as well as for warming up before the match. These match balls must be the same as those used for the match.
- 50.02** The applicable official UEFA Champions League match ball determined by the UEFA administration must be used for all matches from the play-offs onwards and for the official training sessions before these matches.
- 50.03** For all matches, a multi-ball system must be used. As of the play-offs, the system implemented must be in accordance with the protocol and guidelines issued by the UEFA administration.
- 50.04** The use of two-sided substitution boards (preferably electronic) is compulsory.
- 50.05** For each match in the qualifying phase, the home team must ensure that two substitution boards are available.

Article 51 Use of roofs and clocks

- 51.01** Before the match, the UEFA match delegate, in consultation with the referee, decides whether a stadium's retractable roof will be open or closed during the match. This decision must be announced at the organisational meeting, although it may subsequently be altered at any time prior to kick-off if the weather changes, again in consultation with the referee and the UEFA match delegate.
- 51.02** If the match starts with the roof closed, it must remain closed until half-time or for the entire match. If the match starts with the roof open, only the referee has the authority to order its closure during the match, subject to any applicable laws issued by the relevant competent authorities. Such a decision may only be taken if the weather seriously deteriorates. If the referee does order the roof to be closed during the match, it must remain closed until half-time or for the entire match.
- 51.03** Stadium clocks may be used to show the amount of time played or remaining provided they are stopped at the end of normal time in each half, i.e. after 45 and 90 minutes respectively. This stipulation also applies in the event of extra time (i.e. after 105 and 120 minutes).

Article 52 Screens and footage of matches

- 52.01** Simultaneous transmissions, replays and delayed footage of the match being played in the stadium may be transmitted on the stadium's giant screen provided that the host club has obtained all the necessary third-party permission to transmit such footage, including permission from the relevant UEFA match officer and any relevant competent authorities. However, the host club must ensure that replays and delayed footage are shown on the giant screen during the match only when the ball is out of play, during the half-time interval, during the break before any extra

time, during the half-time interval during any extra time and/or before the start of any penalty shoot-out. Moreover, the host club must ensure that any footage shown on the giant screen is in line with the *UEFA Champions League Club Manual* and under no circumstances includes any images that:

- a. may have an impact on the playing of the match;
- b. may be reasonably considered as controversial insofar as they are likely to encourage or incite any form of crowd disorder;
- c. may display any public disorder, civil disobedience or any commercial and/or offensive material within the crowd or on the pitch;
- d. consist of any action or any behaviour that is against the principles of fair play, including any images that are aimed at highlighting, directly or indirectly, any offside offence, foul or potential mistake of a referee;
- e. are accompanied by sound.

VAR footage and GLT replays may not be shown on existing screens in the stadium, unless UEFA decides otherwise. Simultaneous transmissions and replays of the match are authorised for press monitors and closed-circuit channels. The results of other matches can be shown on the scoreboard and/or giant screen during the match.

52.02 If requested by UEFA, clubs must exclusively display on giant screens in the stadium a special video feed featuring the UEFA Champions League branding and including information and images from all matches of the competition.

52.03 From the play-offs onwards, simultaneous or delayed transmissions on public screens outside the stadium in which a match is played (e.g. in the stadium of the away club or in any public place) may be authorised, subject to:

- a. a licence being granted by UEFA at its sole discretion, after consultation with the audiovisual right-holders in the territory of the screening; and
- b. authorisation being granted by the relevant competent authorities.

52.04 Up to and including the third qualifying round, such transmissions on public screens are subject to the terms of [Paragraph 71.01](#).

Article 53 Match protocol

53.01 The UEFA and UEFA Respect flags and any other flag determined by UEFA must be flown at the stadium at all matches in the competition. They will be provided to the clubs by their association. From the play-offs onwards, the competition flag must also be flown. It will be provided by UEFA to the clubs concerned in due time.

53.02 As from the play-offs, the walk-on music provided by UEFA must be played from when the players emerge from the tunnel until they have lined up, at which point the UEFA Champions League anthem provided by UEFA must be played. National anthems may not be played.

53.03 At all matches in the competition, the players are invited to shake hands with their opponents and the referee team after the line-up ceremony as well as after the final whistle, as a gesture of fair play.

IX Teams and Competition Area

Article 54 Teams at the stadium

- 54.01 Both teams must be at the stadium at least 75 minutes before kick-off.

Article 55 Match sheet

- 55.01 Before each match, each team must confirm, using the match sheet, the 23 players in the team and up to 15 team officials, one of whom must be a team doctor. The match sheet must indicate the number and, if applicable, the shirt name that each player will wear during the match.
- 55.02 The players indicated on the match sheet as forming the starting 11 commence the match. A goalkeeper and a team captain must be identified among these players.
- 55.03 If there are fewer than seven players on either team, the match is cancelled or suspended.
- 55.04 Each team must have its match sheet submitted by its competent club official at least 75 minutes before kick-off. The match sheets are automatically exchanged no earlier than 75 minutes before kick-off.

Article 56 Player replacements and substitutions

- 56.01 After the match sheets have been exchanged, no changes are allowed. Before the match has kicked off, the following exceptions are possible:
- Any of the players indicated on the match sheet as forming the starting 11 who cannot start the match due to physical incapacity may be replaced by one of the substitutes listed on the match sheet. The substitute in question may then be replaced by a registered player not previously listed on the match sheet, so that the quota of substitutes is not reduced. During the match, five players may still be substituted.
 - Any of the substitutes listed on the match sheet who cannot be fielded due to physical incapacity may be replaced by a registered player not previously listed on the match sheet.
 - If none of the goalkeepers listed on the match sheet can be fielded due to physical incapacity, they may be replaced by registered goalkeepers not previously listed on the match sheet.

The club concerned must provide the UEFA administration with the necessary medical certificates. Any change made to the players indicated on the match sheet as forming the starting 11 after the match sheets have been exchanged without providing due medical evidence is considered as a substitution, and the number of substitutions available to the team during the match is reduced accordingly. The replaced player may take no further part in the match.

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- 56.02** Up to five of the substitutes listed on each team's match sheet may take part in the match. Additionally, a sixth substitute listed on the match sheet may take part in knockout matches exclusively during extra time. A player who has been substituted may take no further part in the match. Each team may use a maximum of three stoppages in play to make substitutions (one additional stoppage in extra time can be used). Substitutions made before the start of the match, during half-time, between the end of normal playing time and extra time, and at half-time during extra time do not reduce the number of stoppages in play that can be used.
- 56.03** Any player selected on the match sheet in line with [Article 55](#) or replaced in line with [Article 56](#) may be selected to undergo a doping control after the match in accordance with Annex B of the *UEFA Anti-Doping Regulations* and must remain available in the stadium for 30 minutes after the end of the match. If a doping control officer is present at the match and a player selected on the match sheet is injured or falls ill and requires treatment in hospital, the doping control officer assesses the severity of the injury or illness and decides whether the player can leave the stadium to go to hospital immediately or whether they must undergo any potential doping control first.

Article 57 Competition area

- 57.01** The 15 team officials and 12 substitute players indicated on the match sheet, i.e. a total of 27 people, are allowed to sit on the team bench. If the team bench provides fewer than 27 seats, the remaining seats must be accommodated to the side of each team bench (or behind if the team benches are in the stands), with access to the dressing rooms. They must be segregated from the general public and, ideally, covered. The set-up must be the same for both teams. All the substitutes and the team doctor indicated on the match sheet must be seated on the team bench during the match.
- 57.02** The home club must, on request, provide the away club with up to seven seats in the stand for appropriately accredited team delegation staff. These seats must be appropriately stewarded and provide access to the competition area before the match, during half-time and after the match only.
- 57.03** During the match, substitutes are allowed to leave the technical area to warm up in the predefined area confirmed by the referee. Five substitutes per team are allowed to warm up at the same time; however, if space does not permit, the referee may decide to limit the number of substitutes allowed to warm up simultaneously to three per team. The team fitness coach indicated on the match sheet may join the players warming up and is responsible for ensuring that the referee's instructions are respected.
- 57.04** Smoking is not allowed in the competition area. This includes the use of electronic cigarettes.

57.05 The use of any electronic communication equipment and/or systems is regulated by the *IFAB Laws of the Game* and the relevant instructions issued. Under no circumstances may any such systems be used by teams in connection with any kind of refereeing decision or matter.

X Refereeing

Article 58 Referee team and referee liaison officer

- 58.01 The *General Terms and Conditions for Referees officiating at UEFA Matches* apply to the referee teams appointed for the competition.
- 58.02 The referee team is composed of the referee, two assistant referees, the fourth official, two or more VARs (if appointed) and a reserve assistant referee (if appointed).
- 58.03 The referee team is taken care of by a referee liaison officer, who is an official representative of the association of the home club.
- 58.04 Directly after the match, the referee validates the official match report.

Article 59 Appointment and replacement of referees

- 59.01 The Referees Committee appoints the referee team for each match. Only referees from the official FIFA list of referees are eligible. The decision of the Referees Committee is final.
- 59.02 UEFA arranges for the referee team to arrive in the country of the venue the day before the match. If a member of the referee team does not arrive by the evening before the match, UEFA informs the clubs immediately. The Referees Committee takes the appropriate decisions, which are final.
- 59.03 Any referee, assistant referee or VAR who becomes unfit to officiate, or is otherwise incapacitated before or during a match, is replaced by another member of the referee team as follows, in accordance with the *IFAB Laws of the Game*:
- The referee is replaced by the fourth official or by the VAR if one has been appointed and is available on-site, or by an assistant referee.
 - An assistant referee is replaced by the fourth official or by the reserve assistant referee if one has been appointed.
 - A VAR is replaced by the assistant VAR (if certified as a VAR) or by the referee if the latter is unfit to referee but able and certified to serve as a VAR.

If necessary, the match will take place without VARs and/or without a fourth official.

Article 60 Procedure in case of severe injury to players

- 60.01 In the event of a suspected concussion, the referee stops the game to allow the injured player to be assessed by the team doctor, in accordance with Law 5 of the *IFAB Laws of the Game*. In principle, this should take no more than three minutes, unless a serious incident requires the player to be treated on the field of play or immobilised on the field for immediate transfer to hospital (e.g. spinal injury).
- 60.02 Any player suffering a head injury that requires assessment for potential concussion will only be allowed to continue playing after such an assessment, upon specific confirmation by the team doctor to the referee of the player's fitness to do so.

Article 61 Video assistant referees and goal-line technology

- 61.01 VAR and GLT systems may be used in accordance with the *IFAB Laws of the Game* for the purpose of assisting the referee.
- 61.02 No sources or systems other than the official VAR system may be used by the referee to review replays during the match.
- 61.03 The VAR system may be used in all matches of the competition. The decision as to whether the VAR system is used for all or part of a specific match is at the sole discretion of the referee, and that decision is final. The non-use of the VAR system for all or part of a match, whether due to the referee's decision or technical failure or unavailability, in no way prejudices the validity of the referee's decisions, which are final in all cases.
- 61.04 GLT may be used in all matches from the play-offs onwards to help the referee determine whether a goal has been scored. The referee's decision is final in all cases.
- 61.05 In the event of technical failure, matches may take place or continue without the use of GLT. The non-use of GLT for all or part of a match, whether due to the referee's decision or technical failure or unavailability, in no way prejudices the validity of the referee's decisions, which are final in all cases.

XI Disciplinary Law and Procedures

Article 62 UEFA Disciplinary Regulations

- 62.01** The provisions of the *UEFA Disciplinary Regulations* apply to all disciplinary offences committed by clubs, officials, members or other individuals exercising a function at a match on behalf of an association or club, unless the present regulations stipulate otherwise.

Article 63 Yellow and red cards

- 63.01** As a rule, a player or team official sent off by the referee is automatically suspended for the next match in a UEFA club competition (i.e. UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League, UEFA Conference League or UEFA Super Cup). In the event of a serious offence, the UEFA disciplinary bodies are entitled to augment this punishment, including by extending it to other competitions.
- 63.02** In case of repeated yellow cards:
- a. before the league phase, players and team officials are suspended for the next competition match after three yellow cards, that did not result in a red card, as well as following any subsequent odd-numbered yellow cards (fifth, seventh, etc.). Exceptionally, after the completion of every two rounds in a UEFA club competition (i.e. UEFA Champions League and/or UEFA Europa League and/or UEFA Conference League) in which a player was registered on a club's list and eligible to play, the number of yellow cards that player received that did not result in a yellow-card suspension is reduced by one;
 - b. as from the first match in the league phase, players and team officials are suspended for the next competition match after three yellow cards, that did not result in a red card, as well as after any subsequent odd-numbered yellow cards (fifth, seventh, ninth, etc.).
- 63.03** Single yellow cards and any pending suspensions are always carried forward to the next round of the relevant competition (i.e. UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League) in which the player and/or official is eligible to participate or, in the case of pending suspensions, would be eligible to participate, except in the cases described in [Paragraph 63.04](#) below.
- 63.04** Exceptionally, all yellow cards and pending yellow-card suspensions expire on completion of the play-offs. They are not carried forward to the league phase. In addition, all yellow cards expire on completion of the quarter-finals. They are not carried forward to the semi-finals.
- 63.05** All yellow cards and pending yellow-card suspensions from the UEFA Champions League, UEFA Europa League or UEFA Conference League expire at the end of the season.

Article 64 Protests

- 64.01 Participating clubs are entitled to file a protest against the validity of a match result, which will be considered by the competent disciplinary body provided such protest and a proof of payment of the applicable protest fee reach UEFA within 24 hours of the end of the match in question, in accordance with the relevant provisions of the *UEFA Disciplinary Regulations*.